

Once the “installer.php” file is run, your first window will look like the screenshot alongside.

You now need to enter the SQL Server name (“localhost” in our case), while the database name will be “vanilla” (as we specified during creation). Finally, you come to the Administrator setup, where you need to specify your admin username and password, along with other details.

You’ll now be taken to the forum window. Explore a bit: you’ll find the settings window quite interesting—lots of powerful options available here! Another popular forum package is IPB (Invision Power Board), the license for which costs \$185 (Rs 8,300).

There you have it. The tools may be different—take your pick—but creating your own forum was never easier!



The installer file being executed from your browser window



Here's where you set up the Administrator account



Your new playground: the admin settings panel